continue the life and struggle of Otto Grotewohl for the victory of socialism in our republic is also great.

Grotewohl's replacement, Willi Stoph – described by Honecker's bodyguard as taciturn, sour, and permanently grumpy – was on hand to greet Leonid Brezhnev's delegation to Berlin for the fifteenth anniversary of the GDR on 7 October 1964. In his first public engagement, Stoph stood rigid alongside Ulbricht and Brezhnev, saluting as a new 'Frog' ground-to-ground missile rolled passed the reviewing stand in a special parade. That evening, unaware of the continued plotting against Khrushchev, Ulbricht entertained Brezhnev at his Döllnsee lakeside residence, where he treated the Russian to a schoolmasterly lecture on economics (these conversations were translated at five-minute intervals). After half an hour of listening to the First Secretary's squeaking, Brezhnev was ushered into a waiting limousine, feigning illness. He had sufficiently 'recovered' by dawn to gear up in boots, duffle coat and stalker to go stag hunting with Honecker, who derived considerable pleasure from their friendship.

Remarkably, amid all this activity, problems at the Berlin Wall kept bubbling back up. In one incident, thirty students from West Berlin had managed to dig one of the most impressive tunnels in the sandy subsoil stretching between Bernauer Straße in the West and Strelitzer Straße in the East. When discovered by border guards a few days after its completion, fifty-seven men, women and children had already crawled out to the West, but many more were still awaiting their turn when GDR troops showed up.

In the fight that followed between the tunnellers and soldiers, border guard Sergeant Egon Schultz was killed when a fellow soldier accidentally shot him. But for propaganda purposes, Honecker claimed Schultz was 'treacherously murdered by shots fired by West Berlin agents', and used his death as part of a campaign against escape attempts and West Germany. Giving the highest visibility to Schultz's funeral, a tearful Honecker provided the graveside eulogy, portraying the young conscript as a heroic martyr: